USA, the UK and Canada. Between 1985 and 1988, Suchcha planned and executed several operations for the Khalistan movement that included indoctrination, recruitment, fund raising and orchestrating terror in Punjab while sitting safely abroad.

'It felt as though he was sitting in a confession box and that made me a little cautious about his intentions. I listened to him but tried hard not to believe what he was saying. He sounded like a possible defector and just the thought was overwhelming. The prospect of having a mole inside Chohan's operational network was exciting. My only worry was whether this man could give the agency his unswerving loyalty/ Mathur recalled.

Mathur did not realise that Suchcha Singh had already made up his mind to turn and this meeting was the result of weeks of soul scorching introspection about his present and the future.

'"Mathur sahib, mainghumne nahi aaya, aap ke liye kaam kame aaya hu. Mujhpe bharosa rakhiye (Mathur sahib, I am not here to sightsee. I want to work for you. Trust me)." I was amazed that he was reading my mind. He was at the top of the Khalistan movement's chain of command and I saw this as a golden opportunity for a ringside view of the militant groups' activities in the West, and the possibility of dismantling them with his help. I was on the edge and needed to make a fast decision. So I asked him bluntly what he could offer me. He smiled and said, anything within his reach. My next question was whether any trained militants were travelling to India this month, or any terror facilitators. He went silent and his face turned red. A few seconds later, he asked for two days' time. When we parted, I prepared myself for the probability that he would not turn up ever again. But I was wrong,' Mathur said.